

SOCIOLOGY

Undergraduate Study in Sociology

The Department of Sociology and Criminal Justice offers course work leading to either a Bachelor of Arts, Bachelor of Science, or a minor in sociology.

Student Learning Outcomes

Graduates of all these programs will understand and demonstrate:

1. General knowledge of sociology
2. Research methods in sociology
3. Critical thinking skills
4. Application of sociology to pressing social issues
5. Sociological and professional values
6. Information technology skills
7. Communication skills
8. Personal and career development

Graduates understand how social institutions, communities, and organizations work and change; they can examine the causes and consequences of conformity, deviance, and inequality. They can apply sociological understanding of human behavior to practical work situations and everyday life. Graduates can read critically, think independently, and communicate effectively about social issues and social policy.

Degree Requirements

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Sociology students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated below for the major.

University Requirements:

International Perspectives	3
U.S. Cultures and Communities	3
See http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/courses/div-ip-guide.html for a list of approved courses.	
Total Credits	6

Communications:

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
One of the following		3
ENGL 3020	Business Communication	

ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing	
ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	
LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
Total Credits		10

World Languages and Culture:

3 years H.S.

2 semesters college	8
Total Credits	8

Departmental Requirements for Sociology Majors

A program of study that meets the needs and interests of the student and department requirements will be developed in consultation with the major advisor. Students must maintain a GPA of 2.0 or higher in their core courses. Programs of study will include:

SOC 1150	Orientation to Sociology	1
SOC 1340	Introduction to Sociology	3
SOC 3020	Research Methods for the Social Sciences	3
SOC 4010	Contemporary Sociological Theories	3
6 credits of 2000+ Sociology courses		6
18 credits of 3000+ Sociology courses		18
Total Credits		34

Bachelor of Arts or Bachelor of Science Degree

In addition to the program of study above, students must select complementary courses that will lead to a bachelor of arts or bachelor of science degree. Programs leading to a bachelor of arts degree will emphasize additional coursework in groups I and III of the general education requirements. Programs leading to a bachelor of science degree will emphasize additional coursework in groups IIA and IIB of the general education requirements. Some of the possible areas of coursework include criminal justice, community (urban and rural) sociology, family sociology, sociology of work, research methods and statistics, social change and development, social inequality, social psychology and sociological theory.

Bachelor of Arts complementary coursework:

STAT 1010	Principles of Statistics	4
or STAT 1040	Introduction to Statistics	
At least 9 additional arts and humanities and/or social science courses		9
LAS approved arts and humanities and/or social sciences courses. General education courses cannot be cross-listed or dual-listed with Sociology courses that count toward the major.		
Total Credits		13

Bachelor of Science complementary coursework:

STAT 1010	Principles of Statistics	4
or STAT 1040	Introduction to Statistics	
At least 9 additional credits in natural science, math, or statistics		9
LAS approved mathematics and/or natural science courses. In addition, these courses may be used: STAT 3010, STAT 4010D, STAT 4040, STAT 4070, STAT 4150, STAT 4210, STAT 4790; PSYCH 4400; HDFS 4490; ECON 3080, ECON 3760; CRP 4510 and WGS 4020. General education courses cannot be cross-listed or dual-listed with Sociology courses that count toward the major.		
Total Credits		13

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits to graduate, **including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level**. You must also complete the LAS world language requirement and career proficiency requirement.

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities and a three-credit course in International Perspectives. Check (<http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/courses/div-ip-guide.html>) for a list of approved courses. Discuss with your advisor how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

Majors must complete both ENGL 1500 Critical Thinking and Communication and ENGL 2500 Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition. According to the university-wide Communication Proficiency Grade Requirement (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencypolicytext>), students must demonstrate their communication proficiency by earning a grade of C or better in ENGL 2500. In addition, majors must also take an advanced course in ENGL 3020 Business Communication or ENGL 3090 Proposal and Report Writing or ENGL 3140 Technical Communication with a grade of C or better.

Sociology, Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) and Bachelor of Science (B.S.)**Freshman**

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
SOC 1150	1 Sociology 2000+	3
SOC 1340	3 ENGL 2500	3
ENGL 1500	3 Social Science Choice	3
LIB 1600	1 Arts and Humanities Choice	3
Arts and Humanities Choice	3 Arts and Humanities Choice	3
STAT 1010 or 1040	3-4	
14-15		15

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Sociology 2000+	3 Sociology 3000+	3
Sociology 3000+	3 Sociology 3000+	3

World Language/ International Perspectives	3-4 World Language/ International Perspectives	3-4
Arts and Humanities Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Elective	3
	LAS 2030	1

15-16**16-17****Junior**

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Sociology 3000+	3 SOC 3020	3
U.S. Cultures and Communities	3 Sociology 3000+	3
Natural Science Choice	2 Complementary Course (approved Arts and Humanities or Social Science course if seeking a BA; approved Math or Natural Science course if seeking a BS)	3
Social Science Choice	3 Electives 3000+	6
Electives 3000+	6	
17		15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
SOC 4010	3 Sociology 3000+	3
ENGL 3020, 3090, or 3140	3 Complementary Course (approved Arts and Humanities or Social Science course if seeking a BA; approved Math or Natural Science course if seeking a BS)	3
Complementary Course (approved Arts and Humanities or Social Science course if seeking a BA; approved Math or Natural Science course if seeking a BS)	3 Electives 3000+	7-9
Electives 3000+	6	
15		13-15

Total Credits: 120-125**Sociology Minor**

The Department of Sociology and Criminal Justice offers a minor in sociology which may be earned by completing 15 credits in sociology

with a minimum 2.0 GPA. At least 9 of the 15 credits must be at the 2000 level or higher, of which at least 6 credits are in courses numbered 3000 level or above. A minimum of 3 credits must be taken at ISU. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college or university requirement.

Students are required to earn credit for the following courses:

SOC 1340	Introduction to Sociology	3
Additional 12 credits in Sociology courses		12
9 credits must be 2000+, of which at least 6 must be 3000+		
Total Credits		15

The Sociology Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.

Graduate Study

The Department offers study toward the **Master of Science** and **Doctor of Philosophy** degrees, with majors available in **Sociology** and **Rural Sociology**, as well as a graduate minor in **Sociology** for students majoring in other departments. The Department offers concentrations in a number of areas, e.g., community studies and development; sociology of families, inequality, food systems, agriculture and environment; criminal justice/criminology; methodology; social change and development; and social psychology. The Department of Sociology and Criminal Justice does not offer a non-thesis option master's degree program.

The Department accepts applicants for the Ph.D. program from students who hold a master's degree, as well as from students who wish to enter the program directly with a bachelor's degree.

Contact information: Kyle Burgason, 202 East Hall, 515-294-9898 or burgason@iastate.edu.

Graduates have a broad understanding of sociology, address complex societal problems, and communicate effectively with scientific colleagues and the general public in both formal and informal settings. They understand sociological theory, conduct research, and are prepared to educate college students and contribute to public policy. Although the Department stipulates no language requirement for either the degree Master of Science or the degree Doctor of Philosophy, specifying competence in one or more languages may be desirable in some instances.

The Department also participates in the interdepartmental graduate major in **Sustainable Agriculture**, and the interdepartmental graduate minor in **Gerontology**.

Course requirements are listed below. Information about examinations, theses and dissertations, Academic Plan Committees and other requirements are available on the Department of Sociology website.

Ph.D. Core Degree Requirements

Although responsibility for determining the student's course work resides with the Academic Plan Committee (APC), the Department of Sociology and Criminal Justice outlines core courses that must be taken by all students. A graduate course taken elsewhere can be substituted for the Ph.D. core requirements with approval by the Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) in consultation with the student's APC.

A minimum of 72 semester credits (including master's degree credits) is required for graduation.

Required Courses for the Ph.D. Degree

SOC 5060	Classical Sociological Theory	3
SOC 5110	Research Methodology for the Social Sciences	3
STAT 5204	Regression for Social and Behavioral Research	3
SOC 5120	Applied Multivariate Statistics for Social and Behavioral Research	3
SOC 5130	Qualitative Research Methods	3
SOC 5340	Race, Class and Gender Inequality	3
SOC 5910	Orientation to Sociology	1
SOC 6070	Contemporary Sociological Theory	3
SOC 6990A	Dissertation Research: General Sociology	1-8
	or SOC 6990B Dissertation Research: Rural Sociology	
14 three-credit elective courses as specified on the AP		42
No more than 12 credits of 5900 (special topics) may be applied toward the Ph.D. degree requirements.		
Total Credits		65-72

Ph.D. Minor / Co-Major Requirements

Required Courses for the Ph.D. Minor

SOC 5060	Classical Sociological Theory	3
	or SOC 6070 Contemporary Sociological Theory	
SOC 5110	Research Methodology for the Social Sciences	3
One of the following two courses:		
SOC 5120	Applied Multivariate Statistics for Social and Behavioral Research	3
	or SOC 5130 Qualitative Research Methods	
Two 3-credit graduate-level courses in Sociology.		6
Total Credits		15

Required Courses for the Ph.D. Co-Major

SOC 5060	Classical Sociological Theory	3
SOC 5110	Research Methodology for the Social Sciences	3

STAT 5204	Regression for Social and Behavioral Research	3
One Course in Advanced Methodology:		
SOC 5120	Applied Multivariate Statistics for Social and Behavioral Research	
SOC 5130	Qualitative Research Methods	
SOC 5340	Race, Class and Gender Inequality	3
SOC 5910	Orientation to Sociology	1
SOC 6070	Contemporary Sociological Theory	3
3 additional three-credit graduate-level courses in Sociology		9
A minimum of 28 total credits is required for the Ph.D. co-major		

Co-Major Requirements for the Graduate Program in Sustainable Agriculture

The Graduate Program in Sustainable Agriculture (GPSA) develops student competence and expertise in the design, implementation, and evaluation of sustainable agricultural systems. The program's curriculum satisfies the formal requirements for the MS and Ph.D. degrees, as established by the ISU Graduate College, and fosters transdisciplinary and systems-level thinking.

The Department does not offer double majors in sociology.

For admission to the co-major program contact the graduate program coordinator.

M.S. Core Degree Requirements

Although responsibility for determining the student's course work resides with the Academic Plan Committee (APC), the Department of Sociology and Criminal Justice outlines core courses that must be taken by all students. A graduate course taken elsewhere can be substituted for the core requirements with approval by the Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) in consultation with the student's APC.

Required Courses for the M.S. Degree

STAT 5101	Statistical Methods for Data Analysis	4
SOC 5060	Classical Sociological Theory	3
or SOC 6070	Contemporary Sociological Theory	
SOC 5110	Research Methodology for the Social Sciences	3
SOC 5130	Qualitative Research Methods	3
or STAT 5204	Regression for Social and Behavioral Research	
SOC 5910	Orientation to Sociology	1
SOC 6990A	Dissertation Research: General Sociology	1-8
or SOC 6990B	Dissertation Research: Rural Sociology	
4 three-credit elective courses as specified on the AP		12
No more than 6 credits of 5900 (special topics) may be applied toward the M.S. degree requirements.		

Total Credits

27-34

M.S. Minor / Co-Major Requirements

Required Courses for the M.S. Minor

SOC 5060	Classical Sociological Theory	3
or SOC 6070	Contemporary Sociological Theory	
SOC 5110	Research Methodology for the Social Sciences	3
Two 3-credit graduate-level courses in Sociology.		6
Total Credits		12

Required Courses for the M.S. Co-Major

STAT 5101	Statistical Methods for Data Analysis	4
SOC 5060	Classical Sociological Theory	3
or SOC 6070	Contemporary Sociological Theory	
SOC 5110	Research Methodology for the Social Sciences	3
One Course in Advanced Methodology:		
STAT 5204	Regression for Social and Behavioral Research	3
or SOC 5130	Qualitative Research Methods	
SOC 5910	Orientation to Sociology	1
2 additional three-credit graduate-level courses in sociology		6
A minimum of 20 total credits is required for the M.S. co-major		

The department does not offer double majors in sociology at the graduate level. Admission requirements to the co-major program are the same as for the major.

Co-Major Requirements for the Graduate Program in Sustainable Agriculture

The Graduate Program in Sustainable Agriculture (GPSA) develops student competence and expertise in the design, implementation, and evaluation of sustainable agricultural systems. The program's curriculum satisfies the formal requirements for the M.S. and Ph.D. degrees, as established by the ISU Graduate College, and fosters transdisciplinary and systems-level thinking.